Work Engagement Policy

Purpose

This policy is designed to establish clear guidelines for team members concerning their working modes and on-bench periods, ensuring transparent communication, fair resource management, and effective work practices. It provides detailed guidance on work hours, communication standards, project alignment, and on-bench resource management.

By offering a framework for smooth transitions between project engagements and bench periods, the policy empowers team members to navigate their roles effectively, contribute to a collaborative work culture, and thrive in a dynamic professional environment.

Scope

This Policy applies to all Team Members at BigStep.

Section1: Guidelines regarding Mode of Working:

- **Work Hours:**
    - The standard working hours for all Team Members are from 10:00 A.M to 7:00 P.M, but this may be subject to change based on the Project to which a Team Member is assigned.
    - For all Team Members, the daily individual Office Hours should be 9 Hours and the effective working hours (after excluding all the breaks) should be a minimum of 8 hours.
    - Half-day working hours for all Team Members must be a minimum of 4 hours, excluding all breaks.
- **Work Schedule & Productivity:**
    - Team Members are expected to take complete ownership of their work & ensure that they are completing and managing their working hours effectively and efficiently.

- Team Members are expected to align their Performance & Deliverables with the performance Benchmarks set for that role and achieve the allocated targets set for them.

- **Attendance in Important Calls / Sync up Meetings / Events:**
  - Team Members are expected to be present for all Important Calls, Sync up Meetings and Events.
  - The HR Team reserves the right to mark a Team Member Absent for the Day in case they're unable to join any such Call / Event without a timely notice to their Manager.

- **Communication:**
  - Team Members are expected to stay online during the working hours, and stay connected via Google Chat & Email, as these are the primary means of communication.
  - Some Project Teams also use Slack or Microsoft Teams, as a communication tool, in which case the Team Members are expected to be available on all three platforms during the working hours.
  - Team members need to ensure that the BigStep Email ID, G-Chat & Slack / Microsoft Teams is installed in their Smartphones.

- **Virtual Meeting Etiquette:**
  - Team Members need to switch on their video during all meetings and calls.
  - Team Members need to ensure minimum noise & disturbances during calls.

- **Tech Support:** In case of any system/laptop related query, Team Members may file a ticket on support@bigsteptech.com.

- **Drive Management:**
  - Team Members are responsible for managing their work related files & folders properly in Google Drive, and not just rely on files locally stored on the company provided Laptops. In case of Data loss due to any circumstances, the Company will not be liable.
  - Team Members are also advised to make regular & frequent use of CodeCommit Repository to avoid the problem of Code loss.

- **Physical Environment:** Team Members need to ensure that their Physical Environment is suitable for Work, along with proper electricity supply and a stable internet connection.
- **Confidentiality:** Team Members are expected to adhere to the company guidelines of confidentiality and ensure that any sensitive information shared with them is not shared with anyone outside the company.
- **Work Plan & Report:** Team Members are required to regularly send in their Work Plan in the Morning & Work Report in the Evening, as per the pre-determined guidelines & format.
- **Attendance Management:** Team Members are expected to Punch-in & Punch-out through HR-One as per their shift timings everyday in order to ensure their attendance is managed properly.
- **Leaves Management:**
    - Team Members are required to inform their Mentor / Manager and apply for leaves on HR-One prior to the actual leave dates.
    - Team Members are advised to avoid unplanned leaves, unless there is an emergency.

- **Relocation:**
    - **Temporary International Relocation:** Team members planning to temporarily relocate to another country with the intention of working remotely must obtain mandatory approval from the HR Team along with their Manager's approval. Such relocations are limited to a maximum duration of 1 month.
    - **Relocation within the Country:** Team Members are required to notify their Manager and the HR Team in advance of any relocation within the country, either permanent or temporary.

Basis of Mode of Working and its Implication

- The Focus will be on Managing by Performance, based on measurable output. Following factors will be taken into account, when deciding the mode of working for a Team Member:
    - Job role
    - Ability to manage the working hours efficiently & effectively
    - Alignment of their Performance & Deliverables with the performance Benchmarks set for that role and achieving the allocated targets set for them.
    - Attendance in important Calls / Sync up Meetings / Events
    - Team, Project & Client Requirements
- To ensure the efficient and effective completion of projects and fulfill the roles within the company, Team Members who are called to work from the office are required to comply with the request. Compliance with this requirement is mandatory.
- The On-boarding and initial Training of all the newly inducted Team Members will be held at the Office Premise, and these Team Members and their assigned Mentors / Managers will be required to be present at the office premises regularly during the early phase in their employment (e.g. for the First Two Weeks), in order to engage fully in the life of the Company and Culture.
- In case a Team Member is required to be present at the Office Premises on a Permanent / Hybrid basis, they will be intimated 3 - 4 Weeks in advance. Whereas in case a Team Member is only required to be present at the Office Premises for a shorter period of time, they will be intimated 2 - 3 Days in advance.

Prospects of Work from Office

- Team Members being called to the Office will be observed under regular course of business, and no additional compensation / reimbursements with regards to Travel, Accommodation, Meals or any other services will be provided.
- Team Members supposed to Work at the Client Office on a Regular or Hybrid Basis will be observed under regular course of business and no special compensation / reimbursements will be given.

- Team Members are also advised to arrange for their own Food & Meals, as there will be no provision for in-house cafeteria facility, due to the dynamic work policy and regular change in the Number of People present at the Office Premises.

Section 2: Guidelines for On-Bench Team Members:

Definition of On-Bench Team Members:

A Team Member is considered on-bench when not actively engaged in a Full-Time Project, wherein they are not dedicated to a long-term project, contributing to the company's ROI. This also includes Team Members contributing only a few hours weekly to an internal project or those temporarily assigned to a project for a duration of a few days.

Performance Appraisal:

- Team members currently on the bench will not be considered for performance appraisal.
- Once a team member is reassigned to a new long-term project, a comprehensive performance review will be conducted after 2 to 3 Months. If the performance is deemed satisfactory, the team member will then be considered for the appraisal process.
- For example, if a team member, who is currently on bench or had been on the bench at any time in the previous few months (during the evaluation period), was initially scheduled for appraisal in January but got reassigned to a project on 15th January, a performance review will take place after 2-3 months from the date of reassignment. If the performance is deemed satisfactory, the team member will then be considered for the appraisal. This ensures that the appraisal process is aligned with active project involvement and accurately reflects individual contributions within that context.

Variable Incentive:

Team Members eligible for any form of incentive will not receive the incentive during the period they are on the bench. Incentive eligibility resumes upon deployment on a project after the on-bench period.

Leave Management:

- On-Bench Team Members will not be eligible for any new leaves, and their leave balance will be adjusted in future months once they're re-assigned to a project.
- They're required to utilize their leave balance during this period. Any remaining leave balance at the end of this period will not be carried forward upon project reassignment.
- On-Bench Team Members are not eligible for leave carry forward or encashment of any leaves left at the end of a calendar year.

For a comprehensive list of details about leaves & their management, please refer to BigStep's Leave Policy.

Notice Period Guidelines:

In the event that an On-Bench Team Member decides to resign from their position, the standard notice period of 2 months will not be applicable. The company reserves the right to waive the notice period and may choose to relieve the team member from their duties immediately upon receipt of the resignation, based on operational needs and project dynamics.

The above guidelines are subject to changes as per the Market / Business Needs.